



Music

Many major musical styles were born in the South, including gospel, jazz, blues, rock and roll, and country. Music permeates the region's culture, and inspires much of its tourism—thousands of people every year visit New Orleans, Nashville, and Memphis for their musical associations alone.



GOSPEL SOUNDS

Nurtured in Southern churches, gospel music resonates with the passion and expressiveness of early African-American Christians. The name “gospel” comes from combining “God” with “spel,” the old English word for story.

NEW ORLEANS

Affectionately nicknamed “the big easy” or “the city that care forgot,” New Orleans symbolizes charm, pleasure, and general indulgence. Founded by French explorers in the 18th century, it was later colonized by the Spanish, and it's this influence that is most evident in the city's distinctive architecture.

New Orleans is famous for its Mardi Gras celebrations, when merrymakers fill the streets.



Friends and neighbors join in by beating the rhythm on empty cardboard boxes.



COUNTRY NOTES

The hub of the country-music universe is Nashville, Tennessee. Influenced by the ballad and folk traditions of early British immigrants, country music uses melodic guitar, fiddle, and voice to express basic emotion. Since it first became popular in the early 20th century, the style has spawned several related genres such as country-rock, western, bluegrass, and rockabilly music.

